

BLOCK CHEESE

A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Curd System

The Wheytpaper — Version 1.0 (Sharp)

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Curdled July 2026 · Best before consensus

“In curd we trust.”

1. Abstract

Commerce on the Internet has come to rely almost exclusively on financial institutions serving as trusted third parties. Cheese, similarly, has come to rely on cheesemakers serving as trusted aging parties. Both systems suffer from the inherent weaknesses of the trust-based model: transactions can be reversed, and cheddar can be pre-shredded. What is needed is an electronic payment system based on cryptographic proof of age instead of trust, allowing any two willing parties to transact directly without a bank, a middleman, or a fromager. We propose a solution to the double-melt problem using a peer-to-peer network of temperature-controlled caves. The network timestamps transactions by pressing them into an ongoing wheel of curd-based proof, forming a record that cannot be altered without redoing the aging. As long as a majority of milk is controlled by honest nodes, the cheese remains sharp.

2. The Problem: Fiat Dairy

Consider the position of the modern cheese consumer. Central cheesemakers can inflate supply at will: in 1950 there was cheese; today there are “Singles.” This is quantitative easing, and we have simply learned to live with it. Meanwhile, your cheddar sits in custodial cold storage at a grocery store you do not control. You do not hold your own keys. You do not even hold your own cheese. *Not your cave, not your cheese.*

History further shows what happens when the state controls the means of coagulation: surplus, mismanagement, and a strategic reserve of approximately 1.4 billion pounds of government cheese stored in caves that answer to no one. The irony that our solution is also cheese in a cave is addressed in Section 9.

3. Consensus Mechanism: Proof of Age

Bitcoin's Proof of Work consumes an estimated 150+ TWh annually — roughly the energy footprint of a mid-sized nation — computing hashes that are immediately thrown away. We propose **Proof of Age (PoA)**, in which value accrues through expenditure of the only truly scarce resource: time. Validators, known as *affineurs*, stake wheels in temperature-controlled facilities (“Caves”). A wheel staked for twelve months accrues Sharpness at the protocol rate. Wheels staked longer become Extra Sharp, then Seriously Sharp, then legally required to be sold at a farmers market. Figure 1 compares network energy consumption.

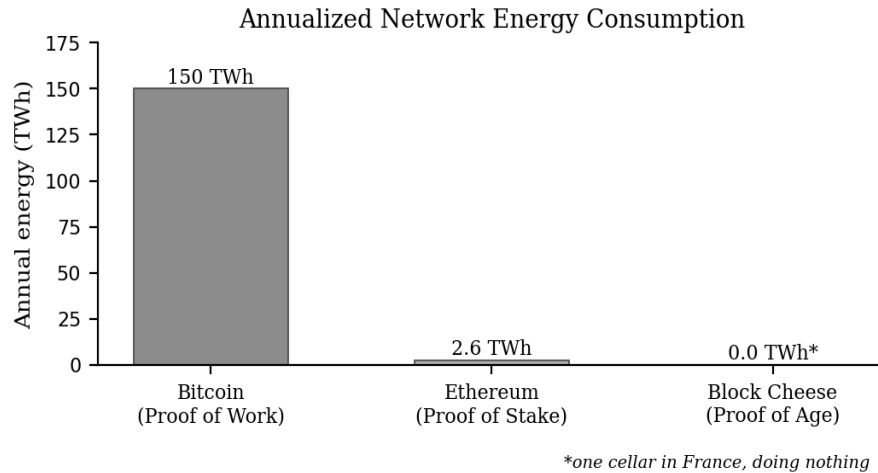


Fig. 1. Energy consumption by consensus mechanism. Block Cheese figures independently verified by a man leaning against a cellar door.

Spoilage. Unlike legacy assets, Block Cheese implements expiration-based deflation. Wheels left unattended — no transactions, no turning, no whispered encouragement — begin to spoil, and spoiled supply is burned by the protocol. We consider this a feature. It is, to our knowledge, the first monetary system in which “this asset went bad” is a technical specification rather than a lawsuit.

4. Network Architecture

Blocks are denominated in **Wheels**. Transactions are confirmed in **Slices** and reach finality when fully cured. Horizontal scaling is achieved not through sharding but through **Curdling**, in which the state is separated into curds (valuable) and whey (gas). Fees are paid in **Whey**, a byproduct nobody wants that is discarded upon use; we note this is identical to existing gas models. Pending transactions wait in the **Churn**.

For high-throughput use cases we introduce a Layer 2, **Fondue**, in which all transactions melt together for speed. Settlement is messy but delicious. Fondue should not be attempted during periods of high network temperature.

5. Wheelnomics

Total supply is fixed at 10,000,000 Wheels — one for each year humanity has aged cheese (source: vibes). Emission is reduced every four years in a scheduled event known as the **Slicing**. Allocation is shown in Figure 2.

Token Allocation (to scale)

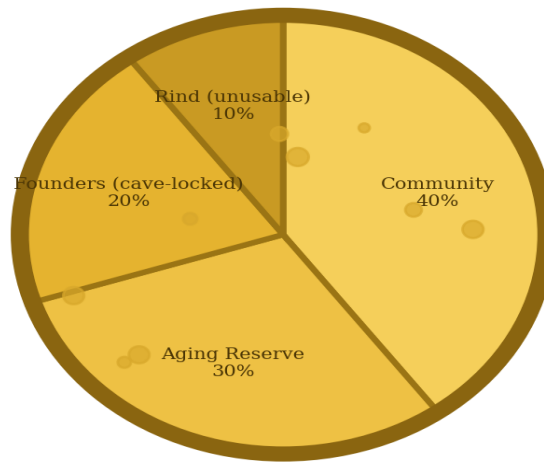


Fig. 2. Token allocation. Chart is to scale. Wheel is not for eating.

The 10% Rind allocation is permanently unusable protocol dust, included for realism. The founder allocation is cave-locked for 24 months, during which it may be visited but not touched, like cheese at a fancy party.

6. Governance: The Cheese Board

Protocol changes are decided by the Cheese Board under one-wheel-one-vote. In practice, governance immediately partitioned into two factions: Gouda holders (patient, long-term oriented, insufferable about it) and Parmesan maximalists (hard, salty, convinced everything should be grated down). Proposal BCIP-7, “*Are Velveeta Holders Eligible to Vote?*”, resolved 9,999,912 to 88 that Velveeta is a “Pasteurized Recipe Cheese Product” and therefore an unregistered dairy security. This remains the protocol’s only hard fork, known as The Processing.

7. Security Considerations

We analyze the majority attack, renamed **Cutting the Cheese**. An adversary controlling 51% of the network’s milk supply could, in theory, cut the cheese at will. However, in every observed instance the party who cut the cheese was immediately identified by surrounding nodes (“whoever smelt it, dealt it” — see consensus literature). We therefore consider the attack self-attributing and economically irrational.

The smart contracts were audited by Gary, a guy at the farmers market who really knows cheese. Gary found no issues. Gary also does not know what a smart contract is. We consider the audit complete.

8. Roadmap

Q1: Milk. Q2: Curds. Q3: Pressing. Q4–Q12: Waiting. Final milestone: **Sharpness**. We decline to commit to dates. Cheese cannot be rushed, and neither can we.

9. Risk Disclosures

This token has no utility, no intrinsic value, and contains no cheese. It may go bad; that is the entire premise. Past aging is no guarantee of future flavor. Block Cheese is not FDIC, USDA, or fromagerie insured. Nothing in this document is financial, legal, or dietary advice. Regarding Section 2: yes, we are also cheese in a cave; the difference is that our cave is decentralized, and we said so in a PDF. If you are lactose intolerant, consult a physician before participating in consensus.

10. Conclusion

We have proposed a system for electronic transactions that relies neither on trust, nor on banks, nor on refrigeration standards. The network is robust in its unstructured simplicity: wheels age, value accrues, and everything that eventually went bad was going to go bad anyway. *In curd we trust.*

References

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